

I started out having received.

No one consented to being born. And yet the name was already chosen, the clothes bought, the place made ready. What was never asked for had arrived first.

Most of what we received is not in memory. Not the back that carried us, not the mouth that taught us words a thousand times over. The part we cannot remember is the part that made us.

Twelve chapters. Each one ends with a box called Someone Comes to Mind. Not something to do. Someone to remember.

The One Who
Was
Already There

Already there before I ever asked

FROM OUTSIDE

the line begins off the page

TO ME



Jaehyuk Choi